Eigen-Séta: performance and security white paper

Measured cost of every operation at every parameter set, security levels, known attacks, risks and open questions

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Abstract

Eigen-Séta v2 is an isogeny-based key encapsulation mechanism whose trapdoor is a secret endomorphism of the public curve. This white paper gives the measured cost of key generation, encapsulation, decapsulation and authenticated public-key encryption on all five parameter sets of the maintained Rust implementation, all measured on one host in one campaign. It then states the security level of each set in the two metrics that matter for NIST's categories, catalogues every attack we know, and ranks the risks and open questions. The specification, proofs and full analysis are in the companion paper [Ano26a]. The short version is as follows.

- Public keys and ciphertexts are 1.3–5.2 kB. A shared secret is 32 bytes.
- On a shared 4-vCPU cloud VM, L1 decapsulates in about 1.2 s and encapsulates in 0.20 s. Key generation is a rejection search, from seconds at L1 to 14 min at Q3. Q5 key generation is the slowest operation of the scheme (§4).
- L1, L3 and L5 meet NIST categories 1, 3 and 5 only in NIST's gate count under MAXDEPTH. At least 2^{λ} quantum queries is met only by L5 (at $\lambda = 128$), Q3 and Q5.
- The largest risk is the hidden orientation of the public curve. If it became effective, it would give subexponential quantum key recovery at every set.

Security is a conjecture. No one outside the project has analysed the scheme. Do not use it to protect data.

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1 Summary

Table 1 is the one-page answer. Every number is measured in run `\BenchRunId` (§4) or derived by the cost model (§6). The record of each value is named in the section that discusses it.

Table 1: The five parameter sets at a glance. Sizes are exact. Times are medians on one shared 4-vCPU VM (§4.1). Security columns are $\log_2$ of the cheapest known attack, from the cost model.

set	NIST cat. (gates)	$\geq 2^\lambda$ queries	$\log_2 p$	pk = ct (B)	sk (B)	keygen (s)	encaps (s)	decaps (s)	classical	quantum queries
L1	1	no	1341	1344	1855	5	0.20	1.20	128.4	64.5
L3	3	no	1991	1992	2730	84	1.14	5.83	192.6	96.5
L5	5	yes (λ=128)	2630	2632	3594	51	2.30	12.78	256.8	128.5
Q3	3	yes	3904	3904	5311	815	5.88	37.34	384.4	192.5
Q5	5	yes	5192	5192	7050	—	—	—	512.7	256.5

Recommended use, if the conjectures hold: L5, Q3 and Q5 for post-quantum deployments; L1 and L3 only where security against classical attack and NIST's gate-count metric are enough.

2 The scheme in one page

Let E_D be the curve with complex multiplication by $\mathbb{Z}[(1+\sqrt{-7})/2]$ ($j=-3375$) over $\mathbb{F}_p$, with $p = 2^{E+1}3^F c - 1$. Write ω for its endomorphism of degree 2, and (P_D, Q_D) for an eigenbasis of ω on $E_D[2^E]$.

Key generation. Draw a secret odd degree f from an interval of about $2^{2\lambda+20}$ values. Find $\alpha \in \mathrm{End}(E_D)$ of norm $f(2^E - f)$ with Cornacchia. Split the Kani isogeny with kernel $\{([f]R, \alpha R)\}$ to obtain $\varepsilon : E_D \to E_A$ of degree f. The public key is E_A with x-coordinates of $\lambda_1\varepsilon(P_D)$, $\lambda_2\varepsilon(Q_D)$ and their difference. These points are eigenvectors of the hidden endomorphism $\tau = \varepsilon\omega\hat{\varepsilon}$. The secret key is a function of f alone.

Encapsulation. Pick s modulo $d = 3^F$. Walk the 3^F-isogeny φ with kernel $P_3 + sQ_3$ to E_C. Push the public basis through it and mask the images by $(a, b) = G(s, H(pk))$. The ciphertext is E_C and three x-coordinates. The key is $H_K(s, ct)$, under the Fujisaki–Okamoto transform with implicit rejection.

Decapsulation. The masks act diagonally on eigenvectors, so the holder of f knows the action of the trace-zero endomorphism $\psi = 2\varphi\tau\hat{\varphi} - tdf$ on the masked points. One $(2^E, 2^E)$-isogeny in dimension two (Kani's lemma, theta coordinates) evaluates ψ on $E_C[3^F]$. Its kernel gives $\hat{\varphi}$ and hence s. The decapsulator then re-encrypts and compares.

Why it is secure, if it is. Without f, the public key is an isogeny of unknown degree f from a known curve, and the ciphertext is a FESTA-type masked-torsion instance [BMP23]. The Castryck–Vercauteren observation [CV23], that an eigenbasis of a *known* endomorphism defeats diagonal masks, is the trapdoor. Hiding the endomorphism's degree is what is supposed to deny it to everyone else.

Figure 1 shows the objects and the attack routes of §7.

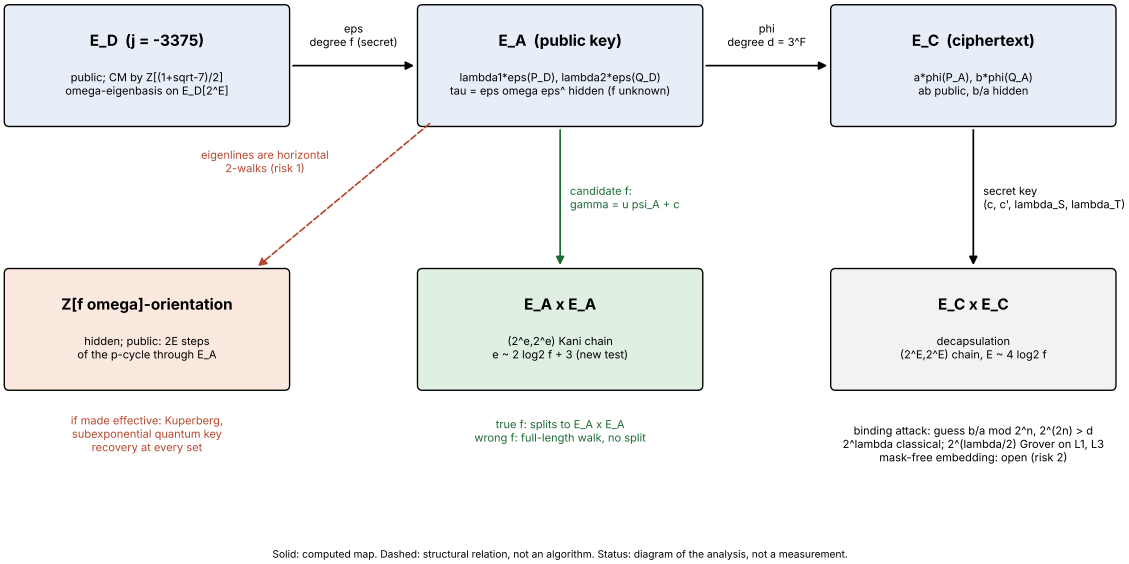


Figure 1: Objects of the scheme and the attack routes considered. Diagram of the analysis, not a measurement.

3 Parameter sets and sizes

The primes come from a deterministic public search [Ano26b]. Fix λ and set $m = 2$ for the L sets or $m = 4$ for the Q sets. Then $F = \lceil m\lambda / \log_2 3 \rceil$, E is the smallest exponent with $2^E > 28 d^2 f_{\max}^2$, and c is the smallest cofactor for which p is prime under fixed-base Miller–Rabin and $p \equiv 3, 5, 6 \pmod 7$. At $\lambda = 128$ and $m = 4$ the search reproduces the L5 prime, so L5 is also the quantum-hardened level-1 set.

Table 2: Parameters and object sizes in bytes. Public key and ciphertext are four $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ elements each. Files add an 8-byte header. A PKE ciphertext is the KEM ciphertext, a 12-byte nonce, the message and a 16-byte tag. Sizes measured by the benchmark (`sizes` rows); parameters from `eigenx:src/params_generated.rs`.

set	λ	$\log_2 p$	limbs	E	F	$\log_2 d$	c	f bits	pk = ct	sk	PKE overhead
L1	128	1341	21	1076	162	256.8	144	277	1344	1855	1372
L3	192	1991	32	1594	243	385.1	1059	409	1992	2730	2020
L5	256	2630	42	2106	324	513.5	380	536	2632	3594	2660
Q3	192	3904	61	3125	485	768.7	371	791	3904	5311	3932
Q5	256	5192	82	4155	647	1025.5	975	1049	5192	7050	5220

The prime grows as $p \approx d^5$, about 10.5λ bits for the L sets. The reason is that one Kani chain must decode an endomorphism of degree $7d^2 f^2$. Two half-chains would cut this to about d^3 (§8.1). That is the single largest efficiency lever.

4 Performance

4.1 Method

One campaign, run `\BenchRunId`, measured every operation on one host: a shared cloud VM with 4 vCPUs (Intel Xeon at 2.10 GHz, one thread per core), Linux 6.18, rustc 1.97.0, release profile, `eigenx` commit `\EigenxCommit`. Isolation is the lowest level (L0): no core pinning for the all-core rows, and `taskset -c 0` for the single-core rows. Other tenants' load is not controlled. The harness is `eigenx:examples/bench_kem.rs`.

- For each set it draws several fresh keys. Key generation is timed in wall time and in process CPU time, because it is a rejection search: a single sample says little, and parallel attempts (`jobs`) trade CPU time for wall time.
- Under each key it runs encapsulation then decapsulation of an honest ciphertext several times, one PKE round trip of a 1 KiB message with associated data, and one public-key degree test, the attacker's oracle (§6). Every result is checked.
- In the same binary it times $\mathbb{F}_p$ and $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ arithmetic.

Samples per set: L1 5 keys × 10, L3 and L5 5 × 5, Q3 2 × 3, Q5 1 × 3, and single-core L1 2 × 5, L3 and L5 1 × 3. The Q sets use `jobs`=4 for key generation; every other row uses `jobs`=1. Medians are reported with the range, because the samples are few and the host is noisy.

4.2 Results

Table 3: Wall time in seconds, median [min–max] over n samples, all four vCPUs available (the KEM uses scoped threads inside decapsulation and encapsulation). Key generation is one attempt loop per key (`jobs`=1 for L, `jobs`=4 for Q). Every decapsulation and PKE decryption returned the right value. Run `run-20261017T2022Z-kem-bench`.

set	keygen wall	keygen CPU	encaps	decaps	PKE enc / dec (1 KiB)
L1 (jobs=1)	4.6 [3.6–6.5], n=5	5.4 [4.5–7.5], n=5	0.204 [0.165–0.304], n=50	1.20 [1.08–1.80], n=50	0.208 / 1.25
L3 (jobs=1)	84.1 [76.5–94.0], n=5	87.8 [79.8–97.3], n=5	1.136 [0.796–1.574], n=25	5.83 [5.40–6.30], n=25	1.038 / 6.24
L5 (jobs=1)	50.6 [39.2–80.3], n=5	60.2 [48.6–89.2], n=5	2.301 [1.744–3.063], n=25	12.78 [11.81–14.90], n=25	2.281 / 13.08
Q3 (jobs=4)	815.3 [689.9–940.6], n=2	2592.3 [2395.0–2789.7], n=2	5.880 [5.381–6.562], n=6	37.34 [36.12–38.49], n=6	5.929 / 37.13
Q5 (jobs=?)	—	—	—	—	— / —

Table 4: The same operations restricted to one core (`taskset -c 0`). Median [min–max]. Run `run-20261017T2022Z-kem-bench`.

set	keygen	encaps	decaps
L1	6.5 [4.6–8.5], n=2	0.240 [0.202–0.341], n=10	1.88 [1.78–2.12], n=10
L3	85.2, n=1	1.055 [1.044–1.086], n=3	9.61 [9.33–9.65], n=3
L5	135.7, n=1	2.938 [2.879–2.992], n=3	22.20 [21.51–25.18], n=3

Table 5: Field arithmetic in the same binary: $\mathbb{F}_p$ and $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ multiplication (best of 15 loops of 20,000) and $\mathbb{F}_p$ inversion (mean of 200). Measured, ns.

set	limbs	$\mathbb{F}_p$ mul	$\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ mul	$\mathbb{F}_p$ inversion
L1	21	536	1674	36,539
L3	32	1760	5479	59,891
L5	42	2957	9019	88,919
Q3	61	5936	18343	152,385
Q5	82	10656	32345	240,125

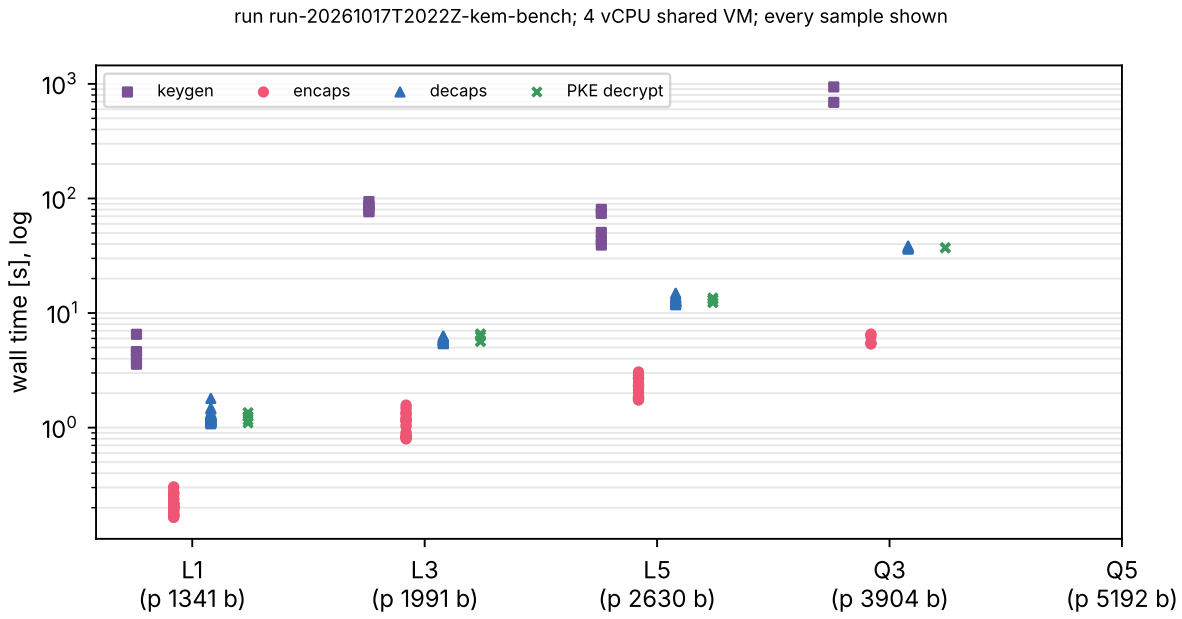


Figure 2: Every sample of every operation, log scale, all cores. Measured; run `run-20261017T2022Z-kem-bench`.

Reading the numbers.

- *Decapsulation dominates online cost.* It is a $(2^E, 2^E)$ theta chain plus pairings and a re-encryption. At L1 it is about six times the cost of encapsulation, a 3-isogeny chain of length F. Across sets it scales roughly as $E \cdot M(p)$, where $M(p)$ is the $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ multiplication time of Table 5.
- *Threads.* Decapsulation runs four independent ladders and the chain's two Montgomery conversions in parallel. On one core it is about 1.6 times slower at L1 and 1.7 times at L3 and L5 (Table 4). Encapsulation barely changes.
- *Key generation is a rejection search.* Its time per key varies by up to a factor of two within a set, so medians over five keys are rough. With `jobs`=4, Q3 used 2.4–2.8 ks of CPU per key, finished in 11.5–15.7 minutes of wall time, and used the four cores at about 75%. L5 key generation is faster than L3 at the median. The rejection rate, not the field size, sets the cost, and five samples cannot resolve the difference.
- *PKE* adds one ChaCha20-Poly1305 pass to the KEM. For a 1 KiB message it is indistinguishable from the KEM times.
- *Comparison with the historical build.* Revision 1 of the companion paper measured decapsulation with a Mumford-coordinate chain: 13.4–15.0 s at L1, 51.8–53.9 s at L3 and 120–124 s at L5, on a 2.80 GHz VM. The theta build is roughly 10 times faster at every L set. Those are different hosts, so treat this as an order of magnitude, not a measured speedup.
- *No external comparison.* No other implementation of this scheme exists, so there is no external tool to compare against.

5 How far off: comparison with other KEMs

Table 6 puts the level-1 set next to the standardised lattice KEM and the closest isogeny-based encryption schemes. Only the ML-KEM row was measured on our host, with the portable RustCrypto crate (`ml-kem` 0.2.3, no AVX2 assembly; record `crypto:research/eigen_seta_whitepaper_20261017/records/mlkem_same_host/`). Q5 key generation was running on all four vCPUs at the time, so these timings are an upper bound. The other rows are as published, on

other hardware and in other languages. Read them as orders of magnitude.

Table 6: Level-1 comparison. Eigen-Séta L1 meets category 1 only in the gate-count metric (§6). FESTA's figures are from a SageMath proof of concept on an Apple M1 Pro at 3.2 GHz. PIKE's are from C on an Intel i7 at 2.3 GHz. POKÉ's sizes and key generation are as listed by the PIKE paper. CSIDH-512 is one constant-time group action (CTIDH, 125.5 Mcycles on Skylake, about 42 ms at 3 GHz). "—" means not reported in the source we read.

scheme	type	implementation	$\log_2 p$	pk (B)	ct (B)	encaps/enc	decaps/dec
ML-KEM-512	lattice KEM	Rust, this host	—	800	768	37 μs	47 μs
Eigen-Séta L1	isogeny KEM	Rust, this host	1341	1344	1344	0.20 s	1.2 s
PIKE (NIST I) [PIK26]	isogeny PKE	C, i7 2.3 GHz	—	—	—	23 ms	15 ms
POKÉ (NIST I) [BM24]	isogeny PKE	SageMath	431	324	648	≈100 ms	≈100 ms
FESTA ($\lambda = 128$) [BMP23]	isogeny PKE	SageMath, M1 Pro	1292	561	1122	3.09 s	9.14 s
CSIDH-512 (CTIDH) [BBC+21]	isogeny group action	C, Skylake	511	64	—	≈42 ms per action	

What the table says.

- *Against ML-KEM* on the same machine, Eigen-Séta L1 is about 5,600 times slower to encapsulate, 26,000 times slower to decapsulate, and about 100,000 times slower to generate a key. Its keys and ciphertexts are 1.7 times larger. Lattice KEMs are in a different league. No isogeny scheme is close to them on speed.
- *Against the best isogeny PKE we know,* PIKE in C, decryption is about 80 times slower and encryption about 9 times slower. That compares across hosts, so take the order of magnitude only. The structural reason is the prime: POKÉ and PIKE work over a field of about $10\lambda/3$ bits, 431 bits at level 1, where we use 10.5λ bits. Field multiplication grows roughly quadratically with size. Their public keys and ciphertexts are 2 to 4 times smaller.
- *Against FESTA,* whose structure is closest to ours, sizes are similar. The published FESTA timings are from SageMath, so no fair speed comparison exists.
- *What would close the gap.* Two half-chains would bring the prime to about d^3, roughly 800 bits at L1 (§8.1). Engineering on the chain step, which measures 2–3 times above the cost model's constant, and on field arithmetic would help further. Our estimate for all of these together is about one order of magnitude. That would put Eigen-Séta level with POKÉ and PIKE, and still three to four orders of magnitude behind ML-KEM.

6 Security level

6.1 How the levels are computed

The levels are *derived*, not measured: no attack in Table 8 can be run at real size. They come from the cost model in `eigenx:src/security.rs`, run by `eigenx:examples/security_estimate.rs` (record `crypto:research/eigen_seta_whitepaper_20261017/records/security_estimate.txt`). For each attack the model gives three numbers: classical operations, quantum oracle queries, and quantum gates under NIST's MAXDEPTH. The gate count uses the parallel-Grover accounting: a search over 2^n items with an oracle of 2^g gates and depth 2^{g-4} costs $2^{n/2+g}$ gates if serial Grover fits the depth limit, and $2^{n+(g-4)+g-\mathrm{MAXDEPTH}}$ otherwise. The model favours the attacker: it ignores memory, uses $p^{1/3}$ for path finding, and charges 2^8 $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ multiplications of Karatsuba cost per $(2,2)$-step.

What we measured. One input of the model can be checked. That is the cost of an isogeny-chain step, which is the Grover oracle's inner loop. The benchmark times the attacker's public-key degree test, a theta chain of e steps, and divides by e and by the $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ multiplication time of the same binary. The result is 583–720 multiplication-equivalents per step in this implementation (Table 7), against the model's $2^8 = 256$. Two things follow. The model's oracle is cheaper than

the best implementation we have, by a factor of about 2.3–2.8, so it errs on the attacker's side. And no tier depends on that constant: changing it by a few bits moves gate counts by the same few bits, and the margins are larger than that except where noted.

Table 7: Measured cost of the attacker's chain step: one public-key degree test of length e for the true f of each key (accepted in every case). "Mult.-equiv." is wall time per step divided by $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ multiplication time. Median over keys. Run `run-20261017T2022Z-kem-bench`.

set	e	time per test (s)	μs per step	mult.-equiv. per step
L1	569	0.63	1122	670
L3	828	2.99	3640	664
L5	1091	6.45	5922	657
Q3	1598	18.69	11697	638

6.2 Levels per set

Table 8: Cost of each attack, $\log_2$ (derived). Chains for the degree search are the public-key test of §7. The hidden-orientation row is a lower bound under the false assumption that the class-group action can be evaluated, not an attack.

target	attack	L1	L3	L5	Q3	Q5
key	degree search, classical (chains)	265.5	396.9	523.5	777.9	1035.5
key	degree search, Grover (queries)	132.7	198.4	261.7	389.0	517.8
key	End(E_A), classical $p^{1/3}$	447.0	663.7	876.7	1301.3	1730.7
key	End(E_A), quantum $p^{1/4}$	335.2	497.8	657.5	976.0	1298.0
key	hidden orientation, $f^{1/2}$ (lower bound)	138.5	204.5	268.0	395.5	524.5
message	mask guess + Kani, classical	129.0	193.0	257.0	385.0	513.0
message	mask guess + Kani, Grover (queries)	64.5	96.5	128.5	192.5	256.5
message	claw on φ, classical $\sqrt{d}$	128.4	192.6	256.8	384.4	512.7
message	claw on φ, quantum $d^{1/3}$	85.6	128.4	171.2	256.2	341.8
classical floor		128.4	192.6	256.8	384.4	512.7
quantum-query floor		64.5	96.5	128.5	192.5	256.5
gate floor, MAXDEPTH $2^{40}/2^{64}/2^{96}$		151/127/98	218/194/162	284/260/228	415/391/359	545/521/489
AES reference (NIST)		130/106/74	193/169/137	258/234/202	193/169/137	258/234/202

6.3 What this means for NIST categories

Tier A: gate count under MAXDEPTH (NIST's stated metric).
L1, L3 and L5 clear the AES-128, -192 and -256 references at all three depth limits. The margins are 21, 25 and 26 bits at the tightest limit. In this metric they are *conjectured* to be categories 1, 3 and 5.

Tier B: at least 2^λ quantum queries against every known attack.
The binding attack on the L sets, Grover over the mask ratio, needs only $2^{\lambda/2}$ queries. That is $2^{64.5}$ at L1 and $2^{96.5}$ at L3, the same exposure as FESTA. Only L5 (at $\lambda = 128$), Q3 and Q5 meet this bar. Recommending L1 or L3 as quantum-hardened would be false.

Classical.
Every set has a classical floor of at least 2^λ. For the Q sets it is about $2^{2\lambda}$.

Both tiers assume the hidden orientation stays ineffective (§8).

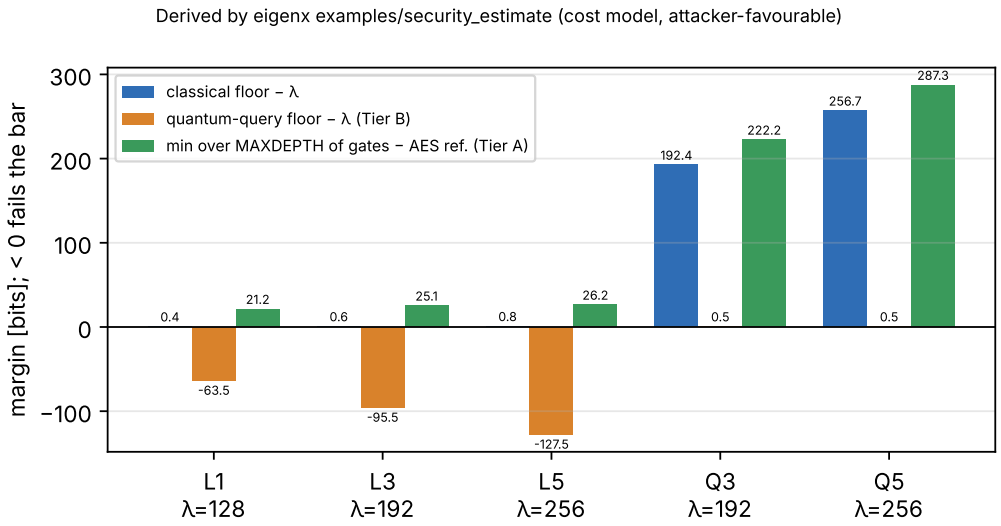


Figure 3: Margin of each set over its target in each metric (derived). A negative bar fails that bar.

7 Attacks

This is every attack we know, with its status. Costs are in Table 8. "Measured" means we ran the attack or its oracle. "Derived" means it was computed from the parameters.

7.1 Key recovery

The secret key is a function of f (measured).
Given f, a working key follows in polynomial time. The Kani scalars come from one sum-of-two-squares, and the eigenvalue scaling is irrelevant. So key recovery means finding f. The test was run on real keys (`eigenx:src/cryptanalysis/degree.rs`).

Degree search with the public-key test (measured; new).
Guess f and test it with a Kani chain of length $e \approx 2\log_2 f$ on $E_A \times E_A$ for $\gamma = u\psi_A + c$, where $\psi_A = 2\tau - tf$ has degree $7f^2$. The test needs no ciphertext and is about half a decapsulation. A wrong guess is rejected only at the final split. Near misses that agree with f on many low bits fare no better, so there is no bit-by-bit recovery. In the 2026-10-17 assessment, 158 wrong candidates across L1, L3 and L5 were all rejected and the true degree was always accepted [Ano26a]. The search space is about $2^{2\lambda+10}$ admissible degrees, so this is not binding.

Generic endomorphism ring or path finding (derived).
ε is with overwhelming probability the unique shortest isogeny from E_D to E_A. So any connecting path yields f after lattice reduction. The cost is $p^{1/2}$ classically, or $p^{1/3+o(1)}$ heuristically with large memory [Wes26], and $p^{1/4}$ quantumly. Since $p \approx 2^{10.5\lambda}$ this is never close.

Meet in the middle on ε (derived).
This needs f to be smooth and its factorisation known. It costs at least $\sqrt{f}$, about $2^{\lambda+10}$.

SIDH torsion attacks on the public key (derived).
The public key gives ε on $E_D[2^E]$ up to a diagonal matrix, with $2^E \gg f^2$. The Castryck–Decru, Maino–Martindale et al. and Robert attacks [CD23, MMP+23, Rob23] need the degree. With f hidden they reduce to the degree search. Hiding the degree is the countermeasure, as in terSIDH and binSIDH [BF23].

Hidden orientation (derived; the main risk).
E_A is oriented by $\mathbb{Z}[f\omega]$, and the public eigenlines are horizontal 2-walks of length E in that orientation. With an effective orientation, the class-group action could be evaluated. Kuperberg's sieve would then recover the key in subexponential quantum time [Wes22], and one endomorphism would give $\mathrm{End}(E_A)$ in $|7f^2|^{1/4}$ classical time [MW23]. No algorithm we know makes it effective (§8).

Self-pairings (derived: not applicable).
These need $m^2 \mid \mathrm{disc}$ for accessible m [CHM+23]. The discriminant $-7f^2$ is odd and prime to 3.

The earlier public-degree variant (measured: broken).
The toy prototype's "walk" variant used a public degree 5^k. Its key is a function of k, and it was broken on 5 of 5 ciphertexts. Version 2 exists to fix this.

7.2 Message recovery

Mask guessing plus a torsion attack (derived; binding).
The pairing reveals the product of the masks but not their ratio. Guessing the ratio modulo 2^n with $2^{2n} > d$ gives the torsion data for Robert's attack. The cost is $\sqrt{d} \approx 2^\lambda$ classically and $d^{1/4}$ Grover queries. This is FESTA's estimate [BMP23] and the binding attack on every set.

Claw finding on the sender's isogeny (derived).
This costs $\sqrt{d}$ classically and $d^{1/3}$ with Tani's algorithm. Tani is no better than classical van Oorschot–Wiener once memory is costed [JS19]. A meet-in-the-middle is implemented in `eigenx:src/cryptanalysis/mitm3.rs`.

Lollipop attacks (derived: not applicable as stated).
The attacks of Castryck and Vercauteren on FESTA and M-SIDH [CV23] need a known low-degree endomorphism with the public basis as eigenbasis. The only such endomorphisms are in $\mathbb{Z}[\tau]$, which has degree at least $2f^2$ and is unknown without f. No element of $\mathbb{Z}[\tau]$ has an eigenline on the 3^F-torsion, because 3 is inert in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-7})$.

7.3 Chosen-ciphertext, implementation and physical attacks

Adaptive and decryption-failure attacks (derived).
FO with implicit rejection answers every malformed ciphertext with a pseudorandom key. The adaptive FESTA attacks [MO23] need a validation or timing oracle, which constant-time decapsulation removes. No honest decapsulation has failed in any recorded run. That is evidence, not a proof that the correctness error is zero.

Timing (partly measured).
The secret phase of decapsulation was shown instruction-count constant on the earlier Mumford build. It has not been re-measured on the theta build. Key generation is variable time by design.

Side channels beyond timing (open).
Leaking α or f through power or EM reduces the scheme to a subexponential quantum problem. Masks are per ciphertext, so the mask-leakage results [DIKM25] apply as to FESTA. Fault attacks on torsion masking [GLM26] also apply, and the FO check is the only countermeasure.

8 Risks, big unknowns and open questions

Ranked by how much would fall if each went wrong.

R1. *The hidden orientation becomes effective.* The public key is a segment of a horizontal 2-walk in the hidden $\mathbb{Z}[f\omega]$-orientation. Turning that into an evaluable class-group action, for example with the level-structure frameworks [FFP24, A$^+$24] or sesquilinear pairings, gives subexponential quantum key recovery at *every* set. Larger parameters do not help, because the Q sets enlarge d and not f. Nobody has tried. **This is the big unknown.**

R2. *A mask-free higher-dimensional embedding.* The subgroups $\varphi\langle P_A\rangle$ and $\varphi\langle Q_A\rangle$ and the mask product are public. A dimension-4 or -8 Kani embedding from these alone would remove the $\sqrt{d}$ search behind every security level. This is open and not ruled out.

R3. *The eigenbasis gives a handle on f.* The attacker knows τ on $E_A[2^E]$ up to the scalar f. We found no use for this beyond guessing f whole, and the public-key test needs all of f. A partial-information attack would break key recovery.

R4. *The decisional assumption.* IND-CPA needs a decisional problem. Every basis is an eigenbasis of some endomorphism, so the assumption is about the size of the smallest diagonal one. It has no argument beyond the absence of a distinguisher.

R5. *Correctness error.* The FO bound has a term $q_D\delta$. We have observed $\delta = 0$ in every run but have no proof for the fixed chain schedule.

R6. *The Grover-oracle constant.* The gate-count tier rests on an oracle cost model. It is conservative by our own measurement (§6), but has had no external review. Tier B does not depend on it.

R7. *Implementation.* Constant-time behaviour has not been re-verified on the theta build. Key generation is variable time. There is no second implementation and no independent check of the known-answer tests.

8.1 Open questions

Q1. Can the two public 2-walks, possibly with level structure or a sesquilinear pairing, make the $\mathbb{Z}[f\omega]$-orientation of E_A effective? (R1)

Q2. Can a Kani embedding of dimension 4 or 8 be built from the masked subgroups and ab alone, without guessing the ratio? (R2)

Q3. Is there a test that rejects a wrong degree using less than all of f, for example modulo 2^j through a smaller endomorphism? (R3)

Q4. Is decisional eigen-CIST well posed, and is there a distinguisher on the size of the smallest diagonal endomorphism? (R4)

Q5. Can the correctness error be proved zero for every admissible key? (R5)

Q6. Engineering: decrypt with two half-chains to bring p from about d^5 to d^3, and add compressed keys and ciphertexts and constant-time key generation.

9 Implementation status

- Rust crate in the sibling repository `eigenx`: constant-time $\mathbb{F}_p$ arithmetic (Montgomery-friendly reduction, safegcd inversion), x-only ladders, 3-isogeny chains, and a theta-coordinate $(2,2)$-chain for decapsulation. It has a CLI with a versioned file format, known-answer tests, hostile-input tests and CI.
- The cost model (`src/security.rs`) and runnable attack components (`src/cryptanalysis/`) are in the same crate.
- A NIST package draft (`docs/nist/`) states what is still missing: an external review of the FO proof, a proof of zero correctness error, constant-time evidence on the current source, a C reference implementation, NIST-DRBG KATs, and timings on the reference platform.

10 Reproduction

- Benchmark: `cargorun--release--examplebench_kem--<set><keys><trials><jobs>` at `eigenx` commit `\EigenxCommit`. Records, host description, graphs and the run report are in `crypto:research/eigen_seta_whitepaper_20261017/`, with copies in `crypto:benchmarks/20261017-eigen-seta-whitepaper/`.
- Security levels: `cargorun--release--examplesecurity_estimate`.
- Specification, proofs and the full analysis: the companion paper [Ano26a], `crypto:papers/eigen-seta/`.

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